

Boston Sunday Globe

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DECEMBER 21, 2025

Days of devastation, tension, heartache

Tragedy tests a steady leader at Brown

By Janelle Nanos, Alexa Gagosz, and Claire Thornton
GLOBE STAFF

Christina Paxson was on a plane to Washington, D.C., last Saturday afternoon when the Brown University president learned that a gunman had opened fire in a classroom on her campus.

It was the day, she said soon after, that she had always “hoped would never come.”

Paxson flew back to Providence and headed to Rhode Island Hospital, where she learned that two students had died and nine were wounded. At about 9:30 p.m., at a news conference with local police, reporters asked her what had happened in the classroom.

“I don’t know,” Paxson said, and looked down. When pressed on why, nearly six hours after the shooting, she couldn’t share

PAXSON, Page A7



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

A few hours after last Saturday’s shooting, a police officer in tactical gear patrolled outside a Brown University building.

What began in a scene of mass horror ended in a cold, isolated storage unit

By Alexa Gagosz, Samantha J. Gross, and Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — The holidays in New England — almost. Snow on this Saturday was in the air on picturesque College Hill, where festive lights twinkled in the gathering dusk and candles winked from windows of the older homes looking on to the campus of Brown University.

Just a few more exams stood between students and winter break — trips home, flights abroad, presents ready to be wrapped, the anticipation of welcome holiday traditions. At a nearby station, firefighters were heating up leftovers for dinner. Twelve days to Christmas.

In the space of 20 minutes, that idyllic scene shattered.

“We possibly might have a shooting victim,” a voice came across police radio at 4:09 p.m. “Stating he was just shot.”

A few minutes later, a blaring alert lit up cellphones of the Brown community: “RUN, if you

SHOOTINGS, Page A6

The trailside to courtside odyssey of new Celtics owner

Nervy moments in pursuit of his passions

By Adam Himmelsbach
GLOBE STAFF

Earlier this year, Bill Chisholm spent several agonizing months finalizing his \$6.1 billion bid to purchase the Celtics.

If he was unable to raise the necessary funds by year’s end, the dream of owning his boyhood team would collapse and he would have to pay several hundred million dollars in penalties.

But in June, the private equity executive faced a more urgent issue while hiking through Virginia’s Blue Ridge Mountains: Are these rat snakes dangerous?

They moved slowly, and he was careful not to agitate them as he found an opening to maneuver by and continue north, never looking back.

For the last three years, Chisholm has spent weeks hiking sections of the Appalachian Trail alone, cooking on a portable

CHISHOLM, Page C12



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Bill Chisholm sidestepped big financial risks in his journey to buy the Celtics.

Find a ray there

Sunday: Some sun, wind. High 43-48, low 21-26.
Monday: Sunny, cooler. High 33-38, low 27-32.
Complete report, **C24**

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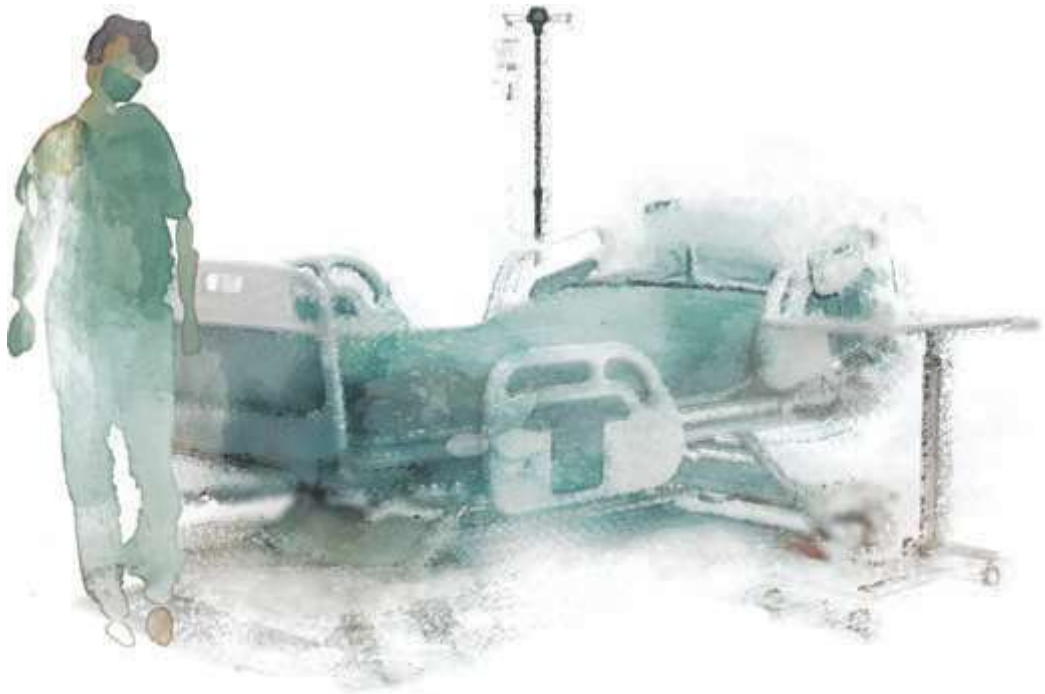


Whether it's TV, movies, pop music, dance, or other pleasures in our lives, we have the top moments of 2025. N1.

The Patriots need to show they have the stuff on Sunday night to beat a good quarter-back, Christopher Gasper writes. **C1.**

Spotlight.

A watchdog for patients, slow to bark or bite



STANDARDS OF CARE
SECOND IN A SERIES

Once relatively aggressive, disciplinary board increasingly fails to hold doctors accountable

By Elizabeth Koh and Liz Kowalczyk
GLOBE STAFF

Dr. Young Ho Oh’s patient was headed for disaster. The woman bled heavily throughout her surgery and lost even more blood afterward. Within hours, an intensive care nurse noticed she had no feeling in her right leg. Worse, the nurse told the doctor, the limb lacked a pulse and was cold to the touch.

But the alarm didn’t seem to register with Oh, an orthopedic surgeon at Harrington Hospital in Southbridge, state records show. He didn’t order an imaging test, perform an exam, or take other urgent steps to recognize there was a blockage in the woman’s femoral artery, choking off her blood supply.

It took more than 24 hours for other specialists to discover the medical crisis — by then it was far too late to repair.

They amputated the patient’s leg.

Oh eventually settled a malpractice claim for an undisclosed amount over the botched 2014 surgery. In

BOARD, Page A10

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